

FINAL GROUP PROJECT

Team members: Rafael and Morgan

Category: Secure Note-Taking App (Security)

1. PROBLEM STATEMENT (2-3 sentences)

What problem are you solving? Who has this problem?

Therapists are required to take note during client sessions that follow HIPAA regulations. Due to most note-taking tools having a lack of encryption and access controls, tools are needed that specifically protect sensitive information regarding the patient. Current solutions lead therapists to choose between security and convenience based on what works best for them and the client.

2. SOLUTION (3-4 sentences)

What is your MVP? What are the 1-3 core features?

SecureNotes is a note taking application with security and privacy first in mind. SecureNotes allows users to secure their notes via encryption and password protection. Notes are mainly created and stored locally as a way to ensure that confidential information is not uploaded to an external third-party but premium/enterprise options allow for sync and collaboration.

3. TARGET MARKET (1-2 sentences)

Who will use this? How many potential customers?

This includes around 190,000+ licensed therapists and mental health professionals in the United States who conduct private practices and clinical work that requires confidential documentation

about their clients. The number of therapists ranges from professionals in private and group practices, community centers, and telehealth platforms.

4. WHY IT'S VALUABLE (1-2 sentences)

How does this solve a real pain point? What's the business value?

Secure Notes aims to provide confidentiality and integrity ensuring that sensitive data typically found in healthcare environments such as health records or therapist notes is stored in a way that complies with security policies. Typical note taking apps such as Microsoft Word, Google Docs, or a text editor don't provide confidentiality conveniently and introduce the risk of uploading internal data to a third-party database.

5. HOW YOU'LL MAKE MONEY (1-2 sentences)

Subscription? One-time purchase? Freemium? Ads?

The foundation for how this application will generate revenue is by hooking users via freemium.

Our freemium version would provide all core features but be limited on scalability and synchronization. Subscriptions will be aimed towards bulk users such as enterprises by supporting synchronization across devices and collaboration between employees.

6. MVP FEATURES (Bulleted list)

- Note creation/editing
- Password-protection (2FA)
- Note encryption
- Auto-logout when inactive for a specific period

7. TIMELINE & DIVISION OF WORK (REQUIRED - NOT OPTIONAL)

Week 1: Rafael - Develop initial prototype | Morgan - Test/Review initial prototype

Week 2: Rafael - Finalize MVP/Presentation | Morgan - Presentation slides

8. TEAM ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES (REQUIRED - NOT OPTIONAL)

Each teammate takes TWO roles (two hats). Choose from:

Product Owner | Lead Developer | Tester | Researcher

Morgan Farrell - Product Owner & Tester

- Responsibility 1 - Gathering info from licensed therapists and getting an idea of their perspectives on documentation with clients. Incorporating features that use AI and includes the number of languages to detect during a recorded session. Compared to other software systems that are currently being used in hospitals/practices.
- Responsibility 2 - Coming up with the structure/flow of the app and scalability ideas. Involving recording options to be sent into the app that generates the notes for the therapists. Dot phrasing into notes, so therapists don't have to write more than they need to.
- Estimated % of codebase: 30%

Rafael Moran - Lead Developer & Researcher

- Responsibility 1 - Develop and finalize the MVP with the core features which includes research on how core features will be implemented (encryption and logout time)
- Responsibility 2 - Refine scalability ideas and areas of improvement

- Estimated % of codebase: 70%

9. VIABILITY: HOW WE'LL PROVE THIS WORKS (REQUIRED - NOT OPTIONAL)

How will you validate that real users want this?

- User testing plan (who, when, how many)
 - Who: Healthcare workers in related fields who talk directly to patients or have managerial/administrative roles. Target small practices.
 - When: We would do this pre-MVP and during Phase 1 to develop our MVP accordingly and rollout core features during phase 1 according to feedback received.
 - How many: 5-10 users pre-MVP and about 100 in Phase 1 to provide success stories that demonstrate improved efficiency.
- Competitive analysis (what exists now, why ours is better)
 - Microsoft Word exists but is too much of a general purpose tool to cover the needs of the healthcare industry
 - Preinstalled or third-party note taking apps can be used to keep data local however they do not provide extensive support or features
 - Specific use apps such as TherapyNotes provides a management system for practices but lacks the core product that we want to bring which is secure note taking
- Market research sources (prove your market exists)

- Over 198,000–600,000 licensed mental health professionals in the US actively need secure documentation tools.
 - The mental health software market is valued at \$6–7 billion (2025–2026) and projected to reach \$18–30+ billion by 2033.
 - High documentation burden and HIPAA compliance needs drive strong demand for secure, convenient note-taking solutions
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- Success metrics (what proves viability?)
 - Clinicians ditch paper or inefficient digital not taking apps for Secure Notes convenience
 - Target users goals outlined in scalability are reached
 - High rates of conversion across subscription tiers, adoption by larger health practices, and high user/business retention

10. SCALABILITY: ROADMAP FROM MVP TO 100K USERS (REQUIRED - NOT OPTIONAL)

Phase 1 (Now): MVP Launch (Now to 3-6 months), target 1k users with core features

- Local note storage with full client-side encryption
- Password + 2FA, auto-logout/session timeout
- Read/Write notes
- Provide HIPAA basic Technical safeguards, mainly audit logging (who accessed when/when)
- Basic templates and search

- Revenue Model (Freemium):
 - Freemium: Free tier for up to 5–10 clients/notes (local-only).
 - Paid Tier: \$9–15/month or \$99/year per therapist for unlimited notes + basic export.
 - Expected: 300–500 paying users → \$3k–7k MRR at 1k total users.

Phase 2 (6 months): Expand to 10k users, add GUI that and subscription for synchronization across devices

- Modern polished GUI
- Secure cloud synchronization across devices (desktop + mobile companion app and web access), “zero-knowledge” architecture so server never sees unencrypted notes
- Advanced templates, voice-to-text dictation
- Basic collaboration via sharing encrypted notes with practice colleagues
- Activity dashboard and not versioning
- Revenue Model (Tiered subscriptions):
 - Basic (\$12/month): Sync + unlimited notes.
 - Pro (\$25–35/month): Team features, priority support, advanced templates, integrations

Phase 3 (12 months): Scale to 100k users, add enterprise features

- AI-assisted note drafting/summarization (HIPAA-compliant by not using user data for training and requiring permission)
- Full practice management: client portal (secure messaging), appointments, basic billing/export for insurance

- Role-based access control (Admin, therapist, assistant, IT department)
- Integrations with popular telehealth platforms
- Enterprise on-premise hosted option
- Revenue Model (Expanded tiers):
 - Individual Pro: \$29–39/month.
 - Practice/Team: \$49–99/month base + per-user add-ons.
 - Enterprise: Custom pricing (annual contracts, on-prem, dedicated support)
\$500+/month per practice + per-user add-ons.

11. SOURCES & REFERENCES (REQUIRED - NOT OPTIONAL)

List all sources for market claims, competitive analysis, and research

- Source 1: TherapyNotes

<https://www.therapynotes.com/>

- Source 2: Mental Health Software Market Size to Reach USD 18.16 Billion by 2033, Driven by Accelerating Digital Care Adoption and AI-Enabled Behavioral Health Solutions - SNS Insider

<https://finance.yahoo.com/news/mental-health-software-market-size-111600268.html>

- Source 3: Preparing for Software Testing: 8 Best Practices for Health Plans

<https://healthedge.com/resources/blog/ps-preparing-for-software-testing-8-best-practices-for-health-plans>

- Source 4: Essential Insights into U.S. Mental Health Workforce: Therapist and Psychologist Demographics and Trends

<https://www.integrativepsychology.org/us-mental-health-workforce-stats>

- Interviews: A licensed therapist (Aime Petrikas)